A great way to use up any white-rinded soft cheese, even if it's strong-smelling. If you don't have celeriac, use a large potato and season with celery salt.

camembert and celeriac soup with cranberry swirl

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
BEFORE CREAM IS ADDED

2–3 tbsp butter
1 onion, chopped
½ small celeriac, about 8oz (225g) prepared weight, coarsely diced
2 cups chicken or vegetable stock
1 bouquet garni
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 cups milk
4oz (115g) ripe Camembert, diced
4 tbsp heavy cream
4 tsp cranberry sauce
4 tsp orange or cranberry juice
4 tsp sunflower oil

1 Melt the butter in a saucepan. Add the onion and cook gently, stirring, for 2 minutes, or until softened but not browned. Add the celeriac, stock, bouquet garni, a little salt, and lots of pepper. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer gently for 15 minutes, or until the celeriac is tender. Remove and discard the bouquet garni.

2 Purée the mixture in a blender or food processor, adding the milk and cheese. Return the soup to the rinsed-out pan, stir in the cream, and reheat, but do not boil. Taste and adjust the seasoning.

3 Meanwhile, whisk the cranberry sauce with the juice and oil until thoroughly blended. Ladle the soup into warm, shallow soup bowls. Whisk the cranberry mixture again and, using a teaspoon, swirl a little of the cranberry mixture in the center of each bowl and quickly draw a toothpick from the center to the edge all around to form a pinwheel-shaped design. Serve immediately.